

Bilateral with Country A

COP31 Brief Buddy · Engagement brief · Singapore delegation

When: Tue 10 Nov 2026, 15:00–15:30 · **Where:** Bilateral Room 4B, Level 2 · **Type:** Bilateral · **Updated:** Tue 10 Nov 2026

Flags: Negotiation-sensitive · Media-sensitive · No new concessions

OBJECTIVE

Secure Country A's support for balanced finance text and confirm alignment on carbon markets.

tone

Warm, purposeful, no new concessions.

COUNTERPART

H.E. Minister A

Minister for Climate and Energy · Country A (major developed economy)

Portfolio: Climate negotiations · energy transition · finance

Public background: Country A's Minister for Climate and Energy since 2024; delivered Country A's national statement at the opening of the high-level segment.

Public sources: Official ministry biography, Opening national statement

MAIN TALKING POINTS

1. Thank Minister A for Country A's constructive role in the coalition this week.
2. Reaffirm Singapore supports ambition where implementation flexibility is preserved.
3. Ask Country A to back the balanced finance formulation and not reopen settled text.
4. Confirm both sides want operational Article 6 rules concluded here.

WATCH POINT — THE ONE THING TO AVOID

Do not commit to any finance figure or language beyond the approved envelope.

IF ASKED / PRESSED

Officials can continue technical talks, but new language must preserve implementation flexibility.

ANTICIPATED QUESTIONS

Q1. Would Singapore support a higher collective finance goal if Country A moves first? [BOTH]

Why it may come up: Minister A publicly tied ambition to 'predictable finance' in Country A's opening statement; the brief flags finance as the active crunch, so a direct linkage is likely.

- » No new finance commitment beyond the approved envelope. [INTERNAL]
- » If pressed, officials may continue technical talks preserving flexibility. [INTERNAL]

» Country A has framed ambition as conditional on predictable support (indicative). [PUBLIC]

FICTIONAL SAMPLE : COP31 Brief Buddy : brief_03-bilateral-country-a : not a real government document

Q2. Can Singapore and Country A issue a joint line on carbon markets? [BOTH]

Why it may come up: Both delegations have signalled carbon markets as a priority; a joint signal could add momentum.

» Openness in principle to a short joint line, subject to clearance — do not agree wording on the spot.

[INTERNAL]

Q3. How does Singapore define 'implementation flexibility'? [BOTH]

Why it may come up: The phrase recurs in both the cleared brief and Minister A's public remarks, so a clarification request is likely.

» Use the framing already in the brief; avoid a new definition that could be quoted. [INTERNAL]

INDICATIVE PUBLIC-DOMAIN NOTES (TENTATIVE — FOR THE ASK FALLBACK)

» Public commentary points to friction between major economies over the finance text, but attributions are contested and unconfirmed. [keywords: block, blocking, stall, who, which country, which countries]

» Minister A has held the Climate and Energy portfolio since 2024 and spoke at the opening — see the Public background panel. [keywords: profile, who is minister a, background, counterpart]